opportunity to dissolve the Constitution in 1992. Erdogan imprisoned thousands of opponents and intellectuals after a failed coup attempt in 2016. Indira Gandhi used the economic and political crisis of 1976 to declare Emergency.

> *The confusion, anxiety, and the profound sense of bewilderment about market forces are inevitable when breadwinners must worry whether income will be enough next week to feed the family . . . You cannot think straight in the midst of hyperinflation. The society becomes unglued.*
>
> Jeffrey Sachs

Let us shift gears away from a fundamental threat to the republic, in a crisis. When there is low state capacity, the day-to-day firefighting in a crisis can yield poor results. For example, India repeatedly had inflation crises in the past decades, and each inflation crisis triggered off a fresh batch of harmful command-and-control measures. The reform which actually mattered—inflation targeting through the Monetary Policy Framework Agreement (MPFA) of 20 February 2015—was not triggered off by an immediate inflation crisis.

Similarly, RBI produced seventy-four regulations in the first fifty days after the demonetization of 2016, and these crisis-management actions were not RBI's finest hour. The 2013 currency crisis had sustained policy activism over a period of months, with many adverse effects upon the economy. [2] Given weak institutions in India, we should dread a crisis.

The third concern is that focusing on opportunities for reform in a crisis tends to understate the value and possibilities from incremental reform. A lot more is possible from the slow process of improving things every day, than is commonly given credit for. The UK got to liberal democracy without anything like a French Revolution. We should not be entranced by dramatic wins; we should have the endurance to engage in 'the slow boring of hard boards' over long decades.

In India, it is often argued that deeper reform will only come about in a crisis. A flip side of this belief is a demoralized view that under normal circumstances, policy reforms are infeasible. We see the policy process as a